



External HDDs

One theme that remained constant across all the brands was adoption of the Super-speed USB 3.0 standard. The second important thing that stood out was the attention paid to the aesthetics. Be it the super slim Seagate GoFlex Slim 320GB drive or the race-car like design on the Silicon Power Stream S10, the drives commanded attention. Portable drives went to capacities of 1.5 TB whereas the powered drives scaled the 3 TB mountain.

If you're looking for an external drive, and are planning to upgrade your system in the near future, please go for a USB 3.0 based drive as it will not only give you great speeds when you upgrade to a USB 3.0 board, but it is also backwards compatible with USB 2.0 ports. Moreover, the difference in the cost per GB of USB 3.0 drives when compared with their USB 2.0 counterparts isn't much.

Zero1 Winner

ADATA Nobility NH03

The Zero1 winner this year was bagged by ADATA Nobility NH03 for its superior performance among all the external drives. It touched speeds as high as 120 MB/s in real-life read tests. It comes in a beautiful black shell and has a one-touch backup button.

Worthy Mention

Hitachi Touro Mobile Pro 500GB

Among the portable drives, the fastest drive that we tested this year was the Hitachi Touro Mobile Pro 500GB drive. It houses a 7200RPM drive within it and this combined with the USB 3.0 interface makes the drive race ahead of competing portable drives. It comfortably crossed the 100 MB/s in read tests. It also was the only drive with a cloud storage option.



EXTERNAL HDDs:
ADATA NOBILITY NH03

Price: ₹9,635



**Hitachi Touro
Mobile Pro
500GB**

Price: ₹8,000



**Kingston Data
Traveller 64 GB**

Price: ₹7,599

Flash drives

USB 3.0 and higher capacities have made an entry in the pen drive segment as well. Four GB pen drives are laughable now when you have 64 GB pen drives available in the market. While we did get a lot of USB 2.0 drives, they are certainly no competition when it comes to performance. Also well designed, rugged drives were in vogue.

Zero1 Winner

Apacer AH552

This is a 32GB drive which comes in a very small form factor and with a USB 3.0 port. A similarly specced Kingston Data Traveller is much bulkier in comparison. But this drive delivered the goods when it came to performance. Scaling a staggering 115 MB/s for sequential read and 71 MB/s for sequential write. Its closest competitor was a good 25 MB/s slower in both, reads and writes. That speaks volumes of what this drive can deliver.

Worthy Mention

Kingston Data Traveller 64 GB

This one's meant for the storage junkies, who want to transfer lots of data, fast. The capacity is enough to use this as a tertiary storage drive for certain files. Performance-wise it was the second best. Also thanks to the huge capacity, the cost per GB is lower than that of the Zero1 Winner.

FLASH DRIVES:
APACER AH552

Price: ₹5,345



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